



Arab Academy for Science, Technology and Maritime Transport

College of Language and Communication

Languages Department

Academic Writing- UNR 1407

Cause and Effect Essay



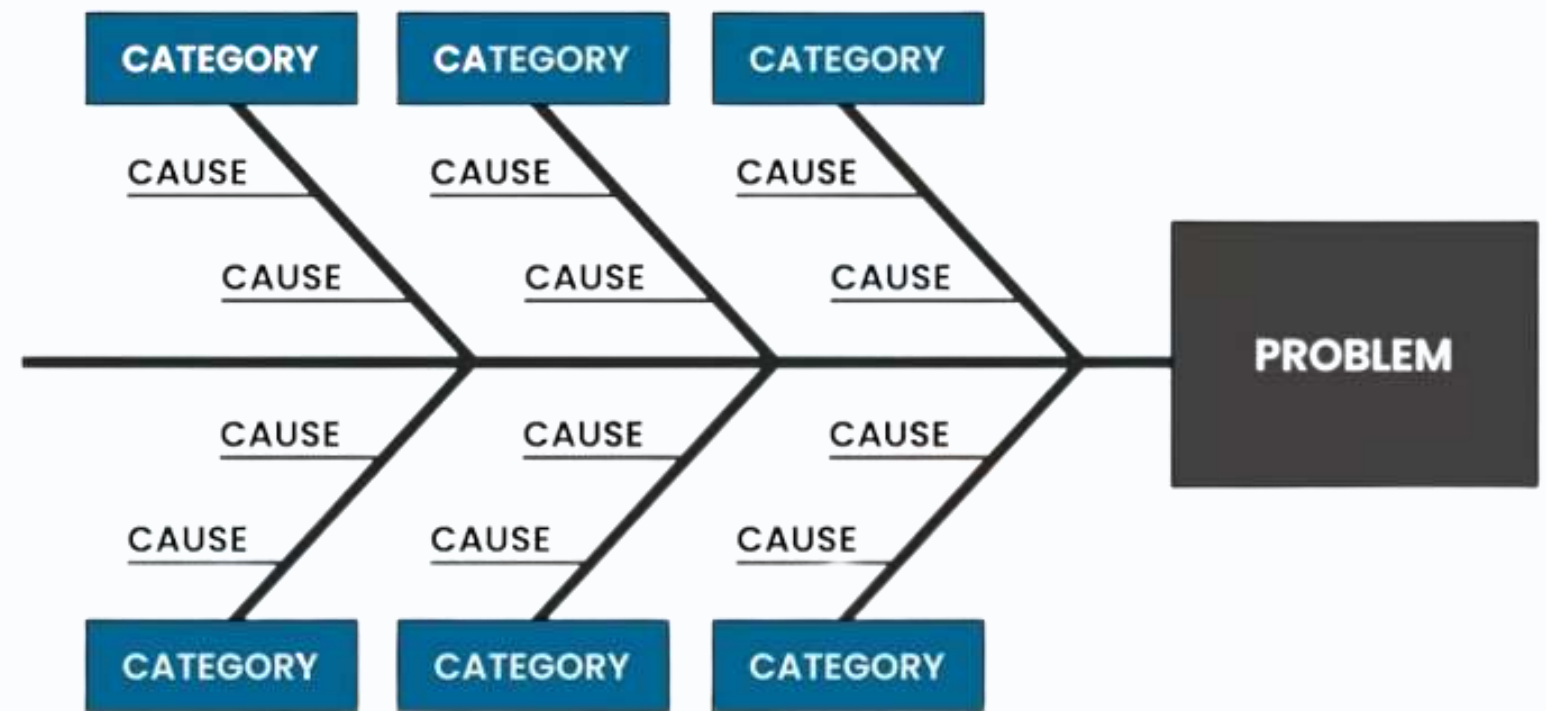
COMPARE & CONTRAST

Points of similarities & differences

- block (Transitional Paragraph)
- point by point

Cause and Effect Essays: Exploring Relationships

- In this type of essays, you discuss **the reasons** (causes) behind a certain **phenomenon**, incident or (problem) and **the consequences** (effects) that resulted from it.
- These **organizational structures** determine how you present the relationship between causes and effects.



Pattern of organization

You can organize the **MAIN SECTIONS** of a cause-and-effect essay as a **block** or a **chain**.

Block	Chain
Introduction Body Paragraph (1): All Causes Transition Paragraph Body Paragraph (2): All Effects Conclusion	Introduction Body Paragraph (1): Cause and its effects leading to ... Body Paragraph (2): Cause and its effects leading to ... Body Paragraph (3): Cause and its effects leading to ... Conclusion

To conclude & introduce

1) Block Organization: Separating Causes and Effects

In block organization, you first discuss all of the causes (in one, two, three, or more paragraphs, depending on the number of causes). Then you discuss all of the effects. You can discuss either causes or effects first.

Introduction

- The introductory paragraph introduces the topic of the essay.
- The thesis statement outlines what the essay will cover (**either the causes only, the effects only, or the causes and**

Body Paragraph 1

Block 1: Causes:

- One or more paragraphs are set to discuss **all the causes** of the situation or phenomenon.
- Each paragraph can cover a different cause, explaining it in detail.

Transition

Connect the two paragraphs with a clear transition (sentence / paragraph).

Body Paragraph 2

Block 2: Effects:

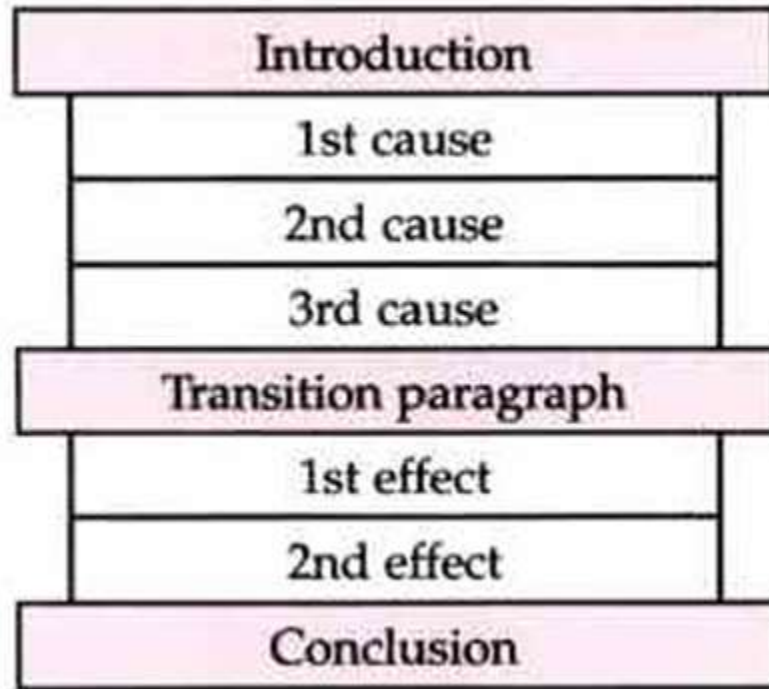
- Following the discussion of causes, give one or more paragraphs focusing on the effects.
- Similar to the causes, each paragraph can deal with a different effect or a group of related **effects**.

Conclusion

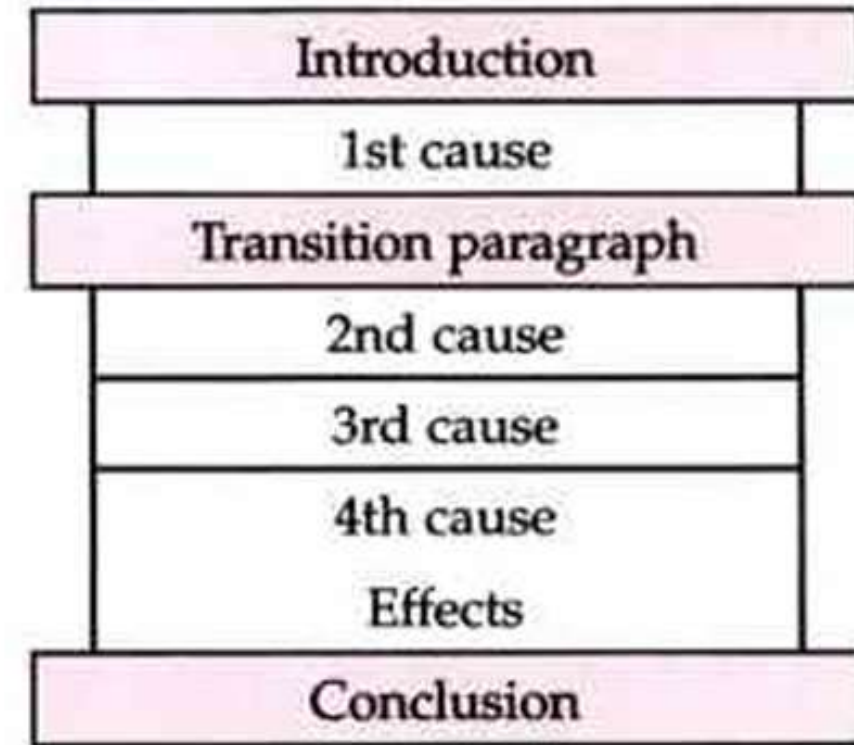
- The conclusion summarizes the causes and effects.
- It may end with a **prediction**, or **recommendation** based on the analysis.

1) Block Organization: examples

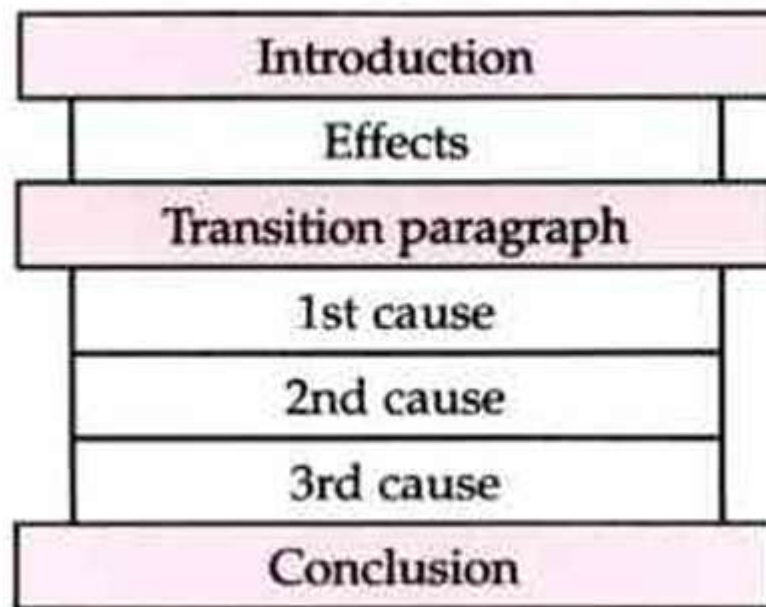
A



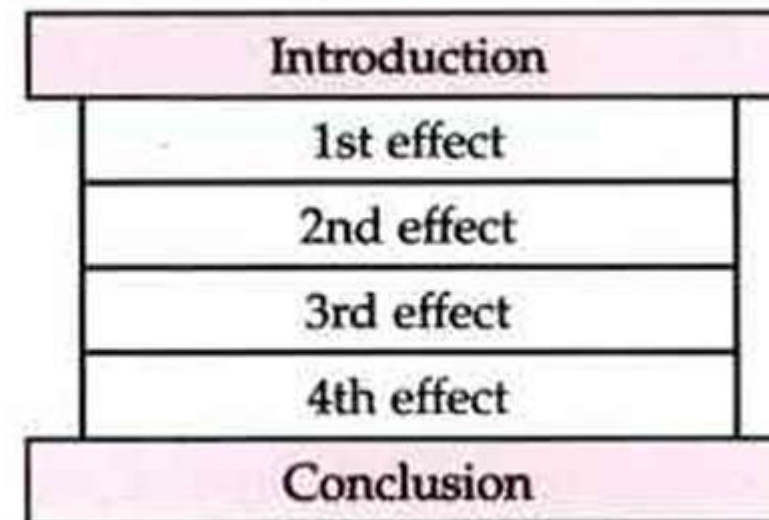
B



C



D



Advantages of Block Organization

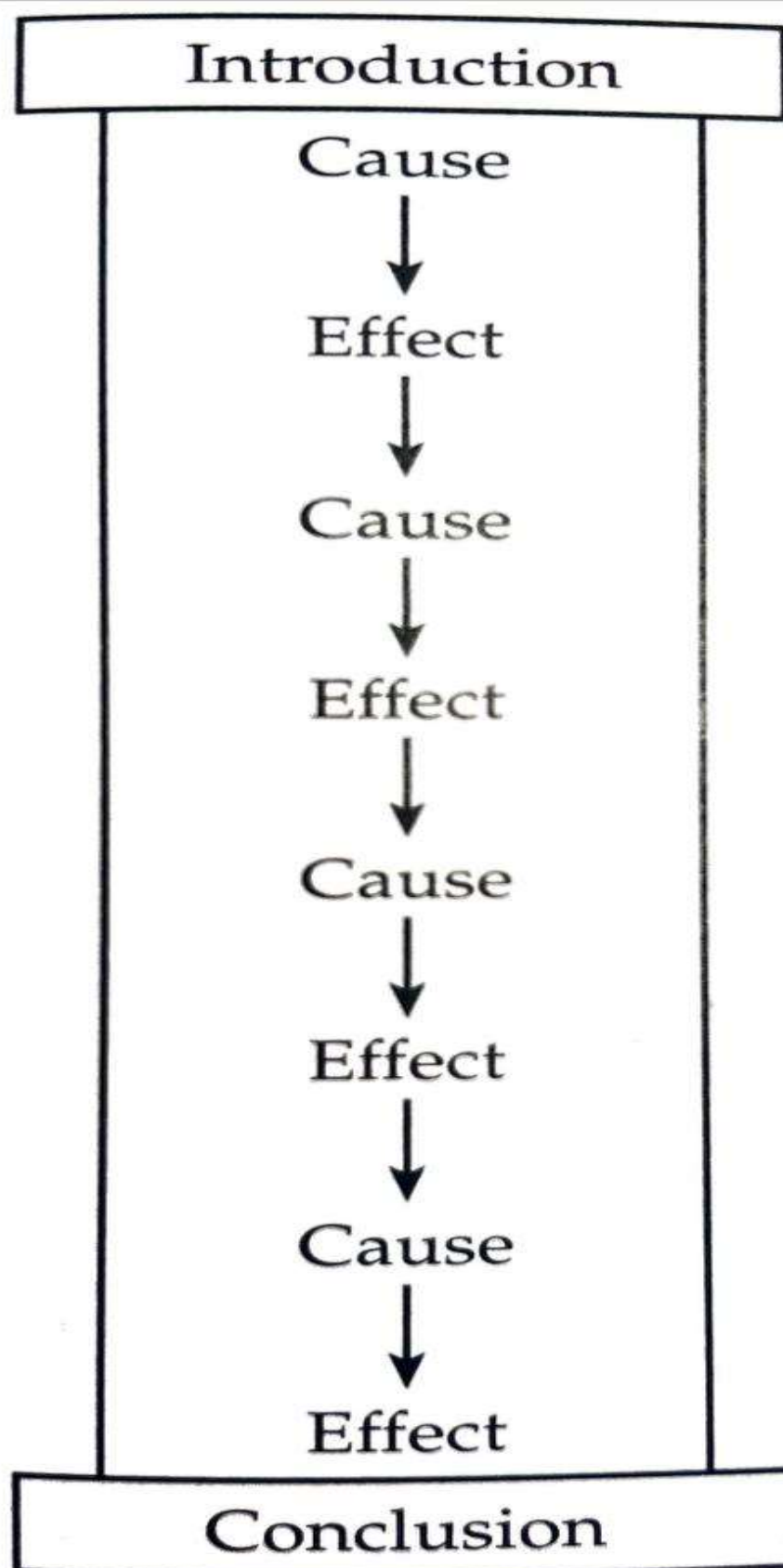
1 Clear Separation

The block structure provides a clear separation between causes and effects, making it easy for readers to understand the distinct elements of the analysis.

- Sometimes, you can write a **transition paragraph** (a short paragraph that separates one block from another block).
- Its purpose: to conclude one section and introduce another.
- It is an **optional** paragraph but it is helpful when your topic is long and complex.

2 Detailed Explanation

This organization is particularly useful when the causes and effects are complex and require detailed explanation, allowing for a careful exploration of each element.



2) Chain Organization: Linking Causes and Effects

1

Introduction

Similar to the block structure, the introduction presents the main topic and the thesis statement that outlines the causes and effects of the essay.

2

Body Paragraphs

B. Paragraph 1: Discusses the first cause and its immediate effect.

B. Paragraph 2: Moves to the next cause and its corresponding effect.

This pattern continues, with each paragraph linking a cause

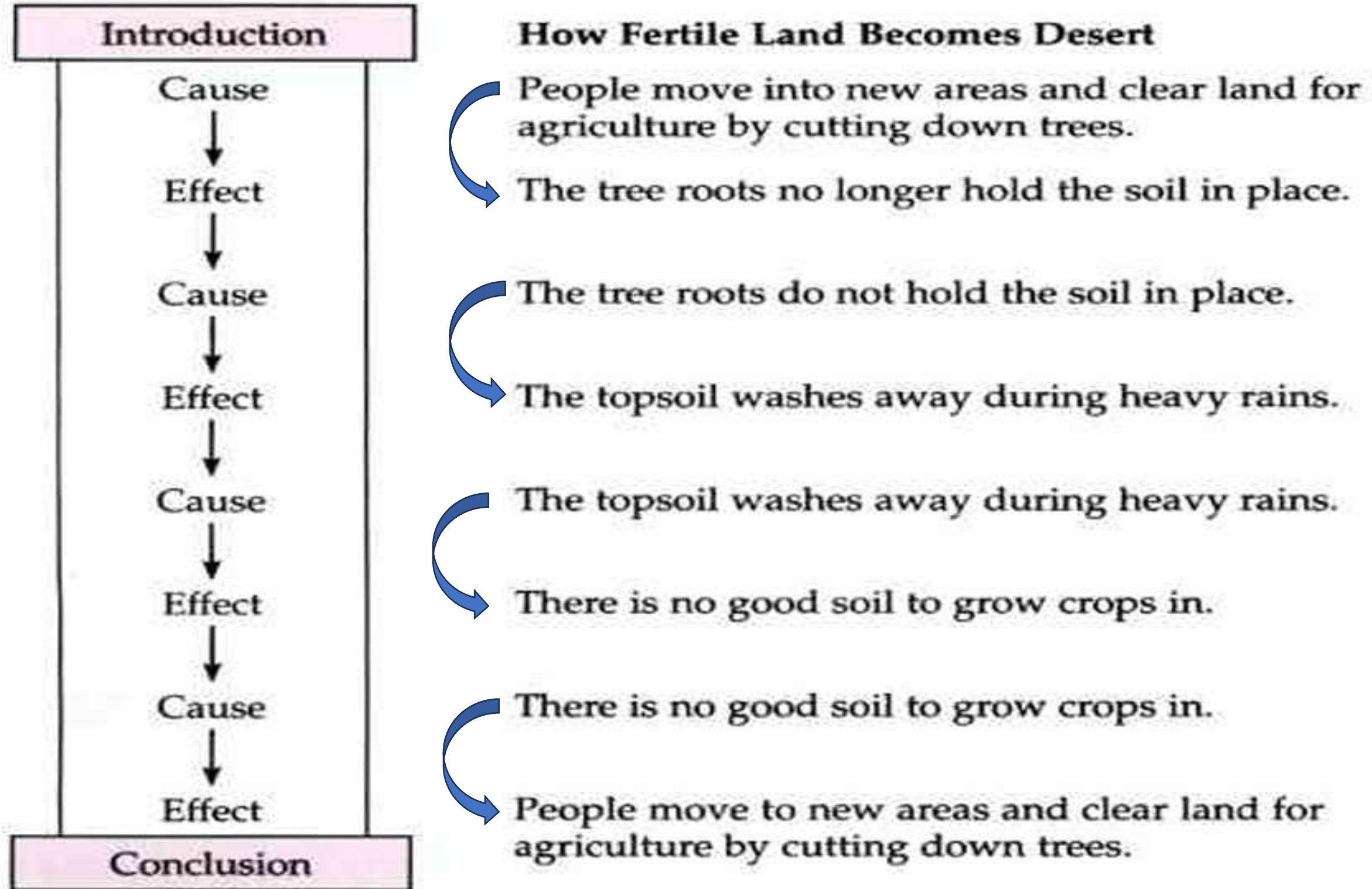
directly to its effect.

3

Conclusion

The conclusion summarizes the cause-and-effect relationships discussed in the essay, and may provide final thoughts, comments, or implications.

1) Chain Organization: example



Advantages of Chain Organization

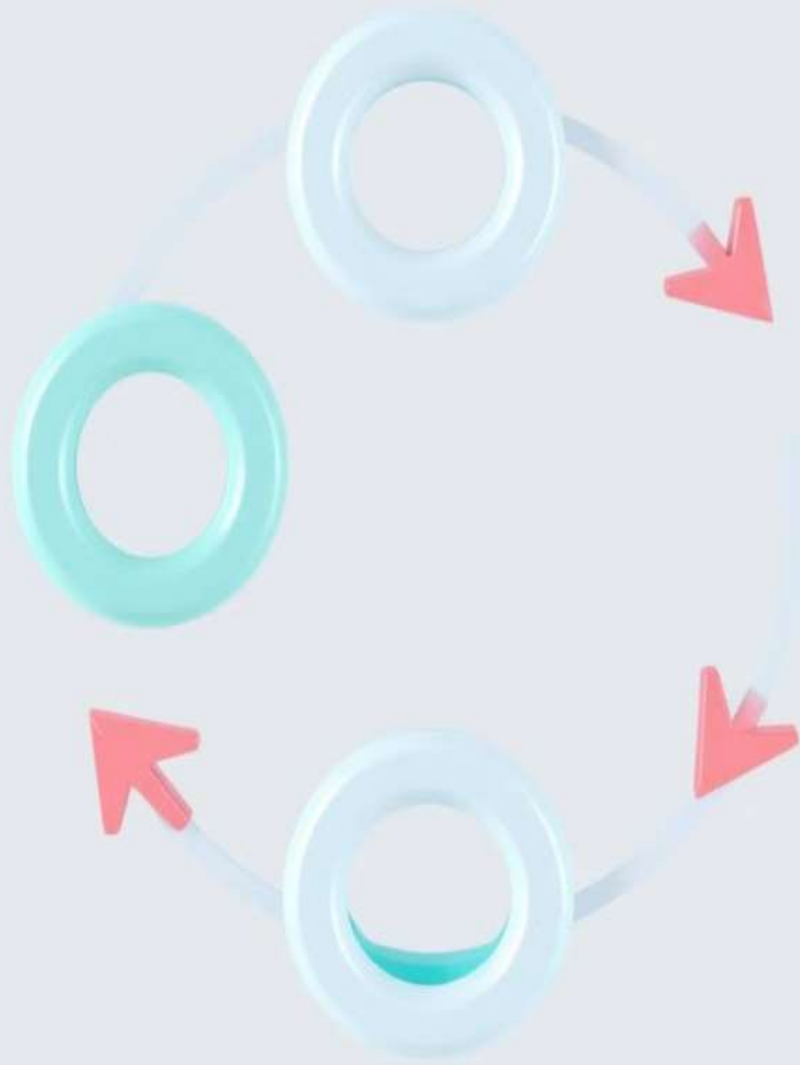
1 Logical Flow

The chain structure provides a direct and logical flow, showing how one cause leads to its effect, which may then serve as a cause for a subsequent effect.

2 Step-by-Step Progression

This organization is useful when the causes and effects are interdependent or related, to reflect the connection between the elements.

Choosing Between Block and Chain Organization



Organization	Suitable For
Block Organization	Several causes and effects to be discussed in depth (<u>not necessarily related to each other</u>).
Chain Organization	A clear and direct cause-and-effect relationship that needs to be presented in a particular order , demonstrating how each effect leads to another.

Practice 1

1. What is the main topic of the essay? **The Causes and Effects of Social Media use on Teenagers' Mental Health**
2. What is the thesis statement of the essay? /
3. Does it have subtopics? **Block**
Does this essay use block or chain organization?

Social media is a big part of many teenagers' lives today, offering ways to communicate, share, and have fun. However, its impact on mental health is a growing concern. ~~Teenagers use social media for several reasons, like wanting approval from others and comparing themselves to peers. These reasons can lead to serious effects on their mental health, such as increased anxiety, depression, stress, and trouble sleeping.~~

One main reason teenagers use social media so much is to feel accepted and valued. Many teens want to gain approval through likes, comments, and followers, which makes them spend a lot of time posting and checking their profiles. Another reason is comparing themselves to others. Teens often look at the pictures and lives shared online and feel they do not measure up. This can make them feel worse about themselves.

These reasons lead to several negative effects on teenagers' mental health. One of the most common effects is anxiety. Many teens feel anxious because they worry about missing out or not getting enough likes and comments. This worry can make them feel restless, nervous, and unable to focus. Depression is another effect, which can happen when teens constantly compare themselves to others or face online bullying. These experiences can cause deep sadness or hopelessness. Additionally, social media can lead to negative experiences, like bullying or harassment, which can create a stressful environment for many teens. Lastly, spending too much time on social media, especially at night, can mess up sleep schedules, which can make anxiety, depression, and stress even worse.

In conclusion, the need for social approval, and comparing themselves to others are some of the reasons why teens use social media, and these lead to problems like anxiety, depression, dealing with online bullying, and poor sleep. It is important to find ways to help teenagers use social media more healthily and protect their mental well-being.

Practice 2

1. What is the main topic of the essay? **The Causes and Effects Poverty**
2. What is the thesis statement of the essay? / Does it have subtopics?
3. Does this essay use block or chain organization? **Chain**

Poverty is a serious problem affecting millions of people around the world. It is often caused by several interconnected factors that can create a cycle that is hard to break. The causes of poverty, such as lack of education and unemployment, lead to effects like poor health, limited opportunities, and social problems, which can then cause more poverty.

One cause of poverty is lack of education. When people do not have access to quality education, they cannot learn the skills they need to get good jobs. This lack of skills leads to the effect of unemployment or low-paying jobs, which means they do not earn enough money to support themselves or their families. As a result, they struggle to afford basic needs like food, shelter, and healthcare.

The effect of low income or unemployment leads to another cause of poverty: poor health. Without enough money, people cannot afford nutritious food, clean water, or medical care. This leads to illnesses that make it harder to work or study, creating another effect where they cannot improve their situation. For example, a person who is often sick may miss work or school, making it even more difficult to find a stable job.

This poor health and limited ability to work lead to another cause: lack of opportunities. People living in poverty often do not have the chance to learn new skills, find good jobs, or move to better places with more opportunities. This leads to the effect of social problems, like higher crime rates or family breakdowns, which make it even harder for people to escape poverty. When communities face these challenges, it causes even more poverty, creating a cycle that is difficult to break.

In conclusion, poverty is caused by lack of education, leading to unemployment and poor health, which then limits opportunities and causes more social problems. Each of these effects can become a new cause, creating a chain that keeps people trapped in poverty. Breaking this cycle requires providing better access to education, healthcare, and job opportunities for everyone.

Practice 3

Read Writing Model 1 on page 117 and answer the following questions:

Questions about the Model

1. Is the topic of this essay primarily the causes or the effects of shyness?
2. Which paragraphs discuss the causes?
3. Which paragraph discusses the effects?
4. What two subtopics are named in the thesis statement?
5. Which paragraph discusses the first subtopic?
6. Which paragraphs discuss the second subtopic?

Practice 3 (Answers)

Writing Model 1, Questions about the Model *(page 119)*

1. It discusses mainly the causes of shyness.
2. Paragraphs 2, 4, 5, and 6
3. Paragraph 7
4. (1) biological factors and (2) environmental factors
5. Paragraph 2
6. Paragraphs 4, 5, and 6

Cause Transition Signals

CAUSE SIGNAL WORDS	
Coordinators	Examples
for	Bison were indispensable to the Native American tribes, for this one animal provided them with nearly everything they needed for survival: meat, clothing, shelter, tools, and weapons. (Note: When used in this way, <i>for</i> has the same meaning as <i>because</i>.) However, you must use <u>a comma in front of <i>for</i></u>, and you must <u>not use a comma in front of <i>because</i></u>.
Subordinators	Examples
because since as	Bison were indispensable to the Native American tribes as this one animal provided them with nearly everything they needed for survival: meat, clothing, shelter, tools, and weapons.

Cause Transition Signals

Others	Examples
to result from to be the result of	The bison's near extinction resulted from loss of habitat and overhunting.
due to because of	Bison nearly became extinct because of loss of habitat and overhunting.
the effect of the consequence of	One consequence of westward expansion was the destruction of habitat for the bison.
as a result of as a consequence of	The areas in which bison could roam freely shrank as a result of the westward expansion of the 1800s.

Cause Transition Signals

Cause
TO SHOW THE
REASON FOR STH

- For this reason
- for
- because
- since
- as
- to result from
- to be the result of
- due to
- because of
- to be the effect of
- to be the consequence of
- as a result of
- as a consequence of

Effect Transition Signals

	EFFECT SIGNAL WORDS
Transition Words and Phrases	Examples
as a result as a consequence therefore thus consequently hence	Workers building the new transcontinental railroad needed meat; as a result, hunters killed bison by the thousands. <i>Note: Notice the difference between as a result and as a result of. <u>As a result</u> is followed by a full sentence (independent clause) and introduces an effect. <u>As a result of</u> is followed by a noun phrase and introduces a clause.</i>
Coordinators	Examples
so	Native Americans began trading bison skins to the settlers for steel knives and guns, so they began killing bison in larger numbers.

Effect Transition Signals

Others	Examples
to result in to cause	Loss of habitat and overhunting resulted in the near extinction of bison.
to have an effect on to affect	The reduced numbers of bison had a terrible effect on the lives of the Native Americans who had depended on them for survival.
the cause of the reason for	Another cause of the problem was the loss of habitat as more farmers moved to the west.
thereby	The 85 bison that survived were given refuge in Yellowstone National Park in 1892, <u>thereby saving</u> this species from total extinction. <u>Note: <i>Thereby</i> is most frequently used in front of -ing phrases.</u>

Effect Transition Signals

- As a result
- As a consequence
- Consequently
- Hence
- Thus
- Therefore
- so
- to result in
- to cause
- to have an effect on
- to affect
- the cause of
- the reason for

Effect

**TO SHOW THE
RESULT OF STH**

Practice 4

page 125

- A** Underline the part of the sentence that states a cause. Circle the word or phrase that introduces the cause.

1. The computer is a learning tool since it helps children to master math and language skills. (*After since, we must use a clause with a subject and a verb.*)
2. Many department stores rely on computers due to their ability to keep records of sales and inventory.
3. A medical computer system is an aid to physicians because of its ability to interpret data from a patient's history and provide a diagnosis. (*How would you rewrite this sentence using because instead of because of?*)
4. War, famine, and ethnic violence have caused a flood of refugees in the past 50 years.
5. Hollywood movies are known for their special effects because U.S. audiences seem to demand them.

Practice 4

page 125

6. Since European audiences seem to prefer movies that explore psychological or philosophical issues, European movies are generally quieter and more thought-provoking.
7. Smog results from chemical air pollutants being trapped under a layer of warm air.
8. John's promotion is the result of his brilliant management skills and company loyalty.
9. Little is known about life on the ocean floor, for scientists have only recently developed the technology to explore it.
10. Holes are created in the protective ozone layer of the stratosphere as a result of the burning of fossil fuels.

Practice 5

page 126

- A** Underline the part of the sentence that states an effect. Circle the word or phrase that introduces the effect.

1. The purchase price of electric cars is far greater than the price of cars with conventional internal combustion engines; consequently, the price must be lowered if they are to become popular.
2. However, electric cars are nonpolluting; therefore, the government offers cash incentives to people who purchase them.
3. In addition, electric cars use relatively inexpensive electricity for power; thus, they cost less to operate than cars that use gasoline.
4. Unfortunately, the operating cost of electric cars only begins to make up for the higher purchase price if a car owner keeps the car for more than eight years; as a result, most people still prefer gasoline-powered vehicles.

Practice 5 page 126

5. His patient diplomacy resulted in the successful negotiation of a peace treaty.
6. It has been documented that lack of sleep affects a person's ability to think clearly.
7. Cold water is denser than warm water and will therefore sink.
8. Freshwater is less dense than saltwater, so it tends to float on the surface of a body of saltwater.
9. Air pollution creates holes in the protective ozone layer of the stratosphere, thereby allowing harmful ultraviolet radiation to reach Earth's surface.
10. The cause of the patient's rapid recovery was the excellent care he received from his doctor.

Practice 6 page 127

Label the sentences in each item as either C (cause) or E (effect). Then combine the sentences to show a cause / effect relationship using the signal words in parentheses. Add, delete, or change words as needed.

1. E There are fewer hours of daylight.

C In winter, the sun is lower in the sky.

(thus) In winter, the sun is lower in the sky; thus, there are fewer hours of daylight.

2. C Some breeds of dogs have a stronger desire to perform a service than other breeds.

E They are more suitable as search-and-rescue animals.

(since) Since some breeds of dogs have a stronger desire to perform a service than other breeds, they are more suitable as search-and-rescue animals.

(continued on next page)

Practice 6 page 127

3. E Seals and other aquatic mammals can see when they are hunting for food in the dark ocean depths at night.

C They have very large eyes.

(due to) Seals and other aquatic mammals can see when they are hunting for food in the dark ocean depths at night due to their very large eyes.

4. C Metals have many free-moving electrons.

E Metals are good conductors of heat.

(consequently) Metals have many free-moving electrons; consequently, they are good conductors of heat.

5. C My company began offering employees flexible working hours.

E Productivity has increased.

E Absenteeism has declined.

(as a result) My company began offering employees flexible working hours; as a result, productivity has increased and absenteeism has declined.

Practice 6 page 127

6. E The temperature of the reactor cooled down.

C The Fukushima nuclear reactor was flooded with cool seawater.

(hence) The Fukushima nuclear reactor was flooded with cool seawater; hence, the temperature of the reactor cooled down.

7. C The earthquake damaged the connection to the power grid.

E The pumps lost electricity and stopped working.

(because of) The pumps lost electricity and stopped working because of the damage from the earthquake to the connection to the power grid.

8. E Weather around the world changes.

C During an El Niño, the jet stream blows in a different pattern.

(therefore) During an El Niño, the jet stream blows in a different pattern; therefore, weather around the world changes.

Practice 6

page 127

9. C In some areas of the world, heavy rains fall.

E Devastating floods and mudslides happen.

(cause—verb) In some areas of the world, heavy rains cause devastating floods and mudslides to happen.

10. E In other parts of the world thousands of people suffer starvation.

C Drought happens.

(as a result of) In other parts of the world, thousands of people suffer starvation as a result of drought.

11. E There was a dramatic rise in food prices in 2012.

C The Midwest of the United States suffered the worst drought in more than 60 years.

(the reason for) The reason for the dramatic rise in food prices in 2012 was that the Midwest of the United States suffered the worst drought in more than 60 years.



Thank you